TECH, EXPLAINED

Notifications without an app

How a website sends pop-ups to a phone.

INSIDE

1 The site asks, once

2 A private address per device

3 The server sends, the browser delivers

4 Android yes, iPhone with a step

5 Why not just build an app?

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The site asks, once

If the person says no, the browser won’t let it keep asking.



A private address per device

The browser gives the site an address for that one device.



The server sends, the browser delivers

The message goes through the browser's own delivery service.



Android yes, iPhone with a step

iPhones need the site added to the home screen first. Apple’s rule.

Why not just build an app?

Two platforms, app store approvals, and an install step where people drop off.

A WEB APP INSTEAD

- Updates for everyone the moment a fix ships

THE RULE

Sometimes the best app is no app.

1. Ask once
2. One address per device
3. Server sends, browser delivers
4. iPhone: add to home screen
5. WhatsApp for must-not-miss

Would your team install another app?

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